THE IMPACT OF CHHATTISGARH has resulted in 4 MILLION people crossing the poverty line.



According to the latest report from NITI Aayog, 40 lakh people in Chhattisgarh have risen above the multidimensional poverty line. The biggest reason for this is the revolutionary initiatives of Chief Minister Bhupesh Baghel. Previously, the state was considered one of the poorest and most backward in the country. However, to eliminate the stigma of poverty, Bhupesh Baghel implemented several welfare schemes as soon as he assumed office, and these schemes had a tremendously positive impact. In these initiatives, he introduced innovations to elevate the standard of living for farmers and the poor. As a result, Chhattisgarh has not only witnessed social development but has also set a new benchmark in economic growth. While some governments traditionally provide opportunities to industrialists to boost the state's economy, Chief Minister Bhupesh Baghel developed an industrial structure through participatory cooperation and the skill development of youth, where women became entrepreneurs in various industries. This way, a new chapter of development is being written in Chhattisgarh, leaving poverty behind.

NEW EMPLOYMENT OPPORTUNITIES WITH AN INVESTMENT OF 78 THOUSAND CRORE RUPEES

A proposal for an investment of 78 thousand crore rupees is being made under the ambit of 167 MOUs for the establishment of new industries. This will provide employment to more than 90 thousand people. Together with the current situation, a total of 177 MOUs are impactful for the establishment of industries, involving an investment of 89 thousand 597 crore rupees and providing employment to 1 lakh 9 thousand 910 people. More than 90 units have initiated commercial production with an investment of over 4 thousand 126 crore rupees in the process of setting up industries by 11 units.

In the category of the country's poorest states, Chhattisgarh, which is now undergoing rapid change, stands out. In just over five years, 4 million people in the state have moved out of multidimensional poverty. The number of poor people in villages has decreased rapidly compared to urban areas in the state. In three districts of the state - Kabirdham, Surguja, and Dantewada - 23 to 25 percent of the population have escaped poverty. According to the NITI Aayog report, between 2015-16 and 2019-21, 13.53 percent of people in Chhattisgarh have risen above multidimensional poverty. Based on the projected population for 2020, this number is more than 3.99 million. The proportion of the population below the poverty line was 29.90 percent in the state in 2015-16, which has decreased to 19.37 percent in 2019-21. This reduction was recorded at 16.07 percent in rural areas of Chhattisgarh, while only 5.58 percent of people in urban areas have crossed the poverty line.

Due to the initiatives of the Chhattisgarh government, over the past five years, per capita income has increased from ₹88,793 to ₹1,33,898. During this period, Chhattisgarh's GDP has grown from ₹3,27,106 crore to ₹5,09,43 crore. Despite economic slowdown due to the COVID-19 pandemic for two consecutive years starting from March 2020, the state's economy has witnessed a remarkable 56% growth in size, thanks to the state government's policies and justice schemes. In the fiscal year 2022-23, Chhattisgarh's development rate in agriculture, industry, and service sectors has significantly exceeded the national average.

> "In the past five years, our government has transformed the image of Chhattisgarh. Soon after coming to power, we coined the slogan 'Gadbo Nava Chhattisgarh' and initiated comprehensive development plans for all segments of our state. Consequently, today, Chhattisgarh is experiencing remarkable growth, not only in its rural economy but also in its industrial and business sectors. The success of our initiatives is evident in the NITI Aayog report, which indicates that four million people from our state have risen above the poverty line during this period. Over the last five years, we have diligently pursued the goal of 'Sarvajan Hitay, Sarvajan Sukhay' (Welfare and Happiness for All). As a result, Chhattisgarh is now gaining recognition as 'Nava Chhattisgarh' (New Chhattisgarh). Our government's efforts have brought prosperity to farmers, tribals, businessmen, and the industrial sector within our state."
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> **Bhupesh Baghel**
> Chief Minister, Chhattisgarh

POSITIVE TRANSFORMATIONS THROUGH GOVERNMENT PLANS

Chhattisgarh government's Suraji Gaon Yojana, Narva, Garva, Ghurva, Badi Vikas Karyakram, and Godhan Nyay Yojana have not only made rural economies more dynamic but have also been effective in economically empowering the rural masses. The Narva Development Programme has helped in water conservation through the treatment of approximately 14,000 seasonal streams in the state, leading to improvements in groundwater levels. It has also increased irrigation facilities and expanded the cultivation of double crops. The Garva program has contributed to the conservation and enhancement of livestock, result-